

June

5

1851

Changing times

US author Harriet Beecher Stowe's novel *Uncle Tom's Cabin* was published in the newspaper *Washington National Era*. The story, about the sufferings of enslaved people in the USA, laid the groundwork for the movement to end slavery.



Born this day

1971 Mark Wahlberg, US actor and film producer. He found fame in the hip-hop group Marky Mark and the Funky Bunch, and has appeared in many acclaimed Hollywood films, including *The Departed*.

1988

Circling the globe

Kay Cottee returned to Sydney Harbour on her yacht *Blackmores First Lady* after completing a non-stop, 189-day journey around the world on her own. The Australian sailor was the first woman to achieve this feat.



Also on this day

1848 The lowest temperature possible, known as absolute zero, was defined by British-Irish scientist William Thomson as equivalent to -273.15°C (-459.67°F).

1883 The long-distance European passenger train *Express d'Orient*, later called the *Orient Express*, began its first journey from Paris, France, to Vienna, Austria.

1972 The UN Conference on the Environment, held in Stockholm, Sweden, was the first international meeting to focus on protecting the environment at a global level.

1956

Elvis the Pelvis

After his first hit single, *Heartbreak Hotel*, US singer Elvis Presley confirmed his status as the King of Rock 'n' Roll on *The Milton Berle Show*.

